

Multiple Syllabuses

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Generated Sep 2026

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Aboriginal Languages K–10 (2022)

Overview

Syllabus overview

Organisation of Aboriginal Languages K–10

The diagram (Figure 1) is an overview of the *Aboriginal Languages K–10 Syllabus*. Across a stage of learning all focus areas need to be taught.

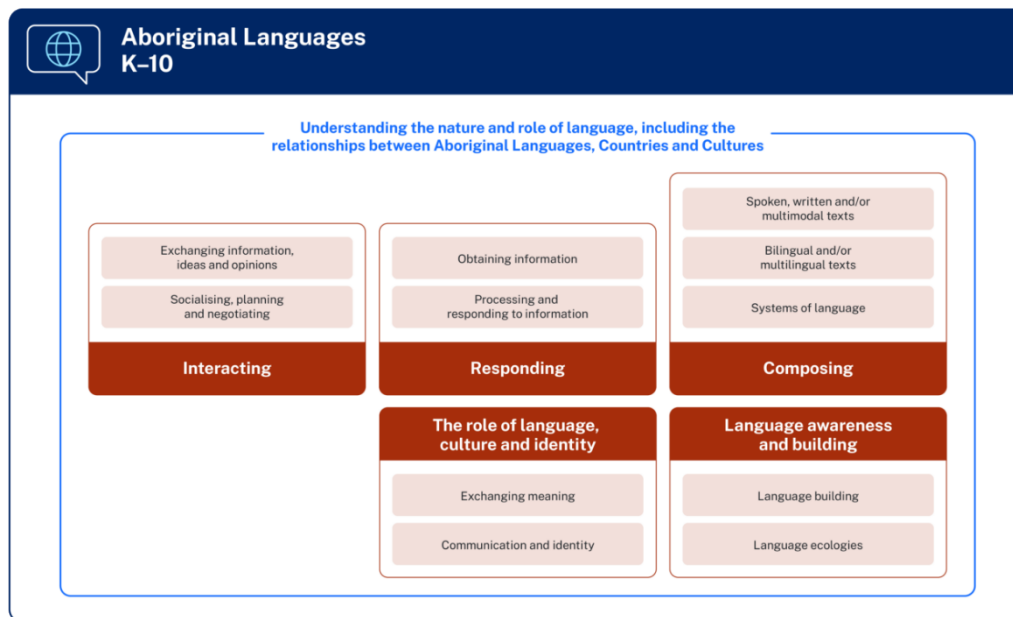


Figure 1: Focus areas and content groups for Aboriginal Languages K–10

Image long description: Diagram displays the 5 focus areas of the syllabus and their content groups. The focus area Interacting has 2 content groups: Exchanging information, ideas and opinions; and Socialising, planning and negotiating. The focus area Responding has 2 content groups: Obtaining information; and Processing and responding to information. The focus area Composing has 3 content groups: Spoken, written and/or multimodal texts; Bilingual and/or multilingual texts; and Systems of language. The focus area The role of language, culture and identity has 2 content groups: Exchanging meaning; and Communication and identity. The focus area Language awareness and building has 2 content groups: Language building; and Language ecologies. A line that circles the focus areas and content groups is labelled, 'Understanding the nature and role of language, including the relationships between Aboriginal Languages, Countries and Cultures'.

Access content points

Access content points have been developed to support students with significant intellectual disability who are working towards Early Stage 1 outcomes. These students may communicate using verbal and/or nonverbal forms.

For each of the Early Stage 1 outcomes, access content points are provided to indicate content that students with significant intellectual disability may access as they work towards the outcomes.

Teachers will use the access content points on their own, or in combination with the content for each outcome.

Decisions regarding curriculum options for students with disability should be made in the context of [collaborative curriculum planning](#).

Life Skills outcomes and content

Students with disability can [access](#) the syllabus outcomes and content in a range of ways. Decisions regarding curriculum options should be made in the context of [collaborative curriculum planning](#).

Some students with intellectual disability may find the Years 7–10 Life Skills outcomes and content the most appropriate option to follow in Stage 4 and/or Stage 5. Before determining whether a student is [eligible](#) to undertake a course based on Life Skills outcomes and content, consideration should be given to other ways of assisting the student to engage with the Stage 4 and/or Stage 5 outcomes, or prior stage outcomes if appropriate. This assistance may include a range of [adjustments](#) to teaching, learning and assessment activities.

Life Skills outcomes cannot be taught in combination with other outcomes from the same subject. Teachers select specific Life Skills outcomes to teach based on the needs, strengths, goals, interests and prior learning of each student. Students are required to demonstrate achievement of one or more Life Skills outcomes.

Protocols for collaborating with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Communities

NESA is committed to working in partnership with Aboriginal Communities and supporting teachers, schools and schooling sectors to improve educational outcomes for young people.

It is important to respect appropriate ways of interacting with Aboriginal Communities and Cultural material when teachers plan, program and implement learning experiences that focus on Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Priorities.

Indigenous Cultural and Intellectual Property (ICIP) protocols need to be followed. Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples' ICIP protocols include Cultural Knowledges, Cultural Expression and Cultural Property and documentation of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples' identities and lived experiences. It is important to recognise the diversity and complexity of different Cultural groups in NSW, as protocols may differ between local Aboriginal Communities.

Teachers should work in partnership with Elders, parents, Community members, Cultural Knowledge Holders, or a local, regional or state Aboriginal Education Consultative Group. It is important to respect Elders and the roles of men and women. Local Aboriginal Peoples should be invited to share their Cultural Knowledges with students and staff when engaging with Aboriginal histories and Cultural Practices.

Creating written texts supports learning

The development of the Aboriginal Languages Syllabus follows Recommendation 2: 'Clarify and strengthen writing content in syllabus documents' from [Teaching Writing: Report of the Thematic Review of Writing](#) (NESA 2018).

Creating written texts facilitates learning as it promotes explicitness, encourages the integration of ideas, supports reflection, fosters personal engagement and aids learners to think about the significance and implication of ideas. Each subject has particular and specific writing demands relevant for communicating within and about the discipline. Writing about content enhances understanding across subjects and stages.

The secondary curriculum includes:

- systematic development of expectations for creating written texts which align with the English K–10 Syllabus (2022)
- explicit writing content to support students to become fluent creators of texts and to deepen their understanding of the subject area
- opportunities to practise the process of creating written texts to develop and communicate knowledge, understanding and ideas
- a focus on development of word consciousness and precise use of subject-specific terminology.

Creating written texts refers to the act of composing and constructing a text for a particular purpose, audience and context.

Various methods of transcription may be employed, and a student's preferred communication form(s) should be considered when teaching.

Balance of content

The amount of content associated with a given outcome is not necessarily indicative of the amount of time spent engaging with the respective outcome. Teachers use formative and summative assessment to determine instructional priorities and the time needed for students to demonstrate expected outcomes.

In considering the intended learning, teachers make decisions about the sequence and emphasis to be given to particular groups of content based on the needs and abilities of their students.

The Languages

The languages to be studied and assessed are the Aboriginal Languages of Australia, with priority given to the Language of Country where the school is located. The term 'target language' is used to refer to the Aboriginal Language studied.

In terms of the language ecologies of Australia, the majority of Aboriginal Languages are in revival. These Language Communities may have some fluent speakers among older generations, but generational transmission has been interrupted within the context of post-invasion Language loss. A small number of Aboriginal Languages are considered to be a first language, used as the Language of everyday communication across all generations of a whole Community.

To cater for Torres Strait Islander Language learners, a Torres Strait Islander Language can be studied in consultation and with permissions from the local Aboriginal Community and the appropriate Torres Strait Islander Community. Exposure to learning or awareness of the Language of Country where the school is located is also recommended.

Students should learn to communicate in the target language, including formal and informal language used in daily life, and an awareness of dialectal and/or regional differences. Students may also learn that the target language has corresponding sign and restricted language.

The learners of Aboriginal Languages

Students come to the learning of Languages with diverse linguistic, cultural and personal profiles, including a range of prior language experiences. Students start school as monolingual, bilingual or plurilingual.

Syllabus content is designed to accommodate the range of student entry points and range of learners, some of whom may have significant prior learning, experience or background in the target language and/or other Aboriginal Languages.

In Kindergarten to Year 6, content is developed for 2 broad student groups:

- students who are studying the target language as Language Revival learners
- students who are studying the target language as First Language learners.

In Years 7 to 10, content is developed and presented in 3 ways:

- students who are studying the target language as Language Revival learners
- students who are studying the target language as First Language learners
- students undertaking a course based on Life Skills outcomes and content.

Community consultation

The successful introduction and ongoing implementation of the *Aboriginal Languages K–10 Syllabus* is underpinned by a firm understanding of key principles and protocols associated with Aboriginal Languages and cultures. NSW schools introducing the *Aboriginal Languages K–10 Syllabus* will ensure success and sustainability by working in partnership with their local Aboriginal Community. The successful delivery of the *Aboriginal Languages K–10 Syllabus* will be dependent on expertise and guidance from local Aboriginal Knowledge holders, Custodians and stakeholders to support classroom teachers.

The local Aboriginal Community of the school is an important partner and should be the first point of contact regarding the introduction of Aboriginal Languages into school-based teaching and learning programs. They are in the best position to provide advice on local protocols. To support implementation of a successful and sustainable Aboriginal Languages program, the local Aboriginal Community will be able to make recommendations regarding Language speakers, tutors, resources and historical contexts.

The protocols for on-Country and off-Country learning of Aboriginal Languages are fundamental to the ongoing maintenance of Aboriginal social and Cultural practices in NSW. For content that invites comparison between the target language and another NSW Aboriginal Language or an Aboriginal Language from elsewhere in Australia, the Knowledge holders, Custodians and stakeholders of that comparative Language will need to be consulted and will need to support their Language being studied off-Country. The support of the local Aboriginal Community Elders and Knowledge holders will also be required.

The syllabus acknowledges the need for appropriate ongoing consultation on the development and implementation of teaching and learning programs in schools. NESA, through the *Aboriginal Languages K–10 Syllabus*, supports the aspirations of Aboriginal communities to maintain and revitalise their Languages and cultures.

For delivery of Aboriginal Languages syllabuses, and for any other units of work with a particular or sustained focus on Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander histories and Cultures, NSW schools should work in partnership with their local Aboriginal Community to ensure successful and sustainable learning outcomes.

Further advice on [Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander principles and protocols](#) is available on the NESA website.

Course description

Courses 7–10

The *Aboriginal Languages K–10 Syllabus* contains both a mandatory course and elective courses.

Mandatory course 7–10

Students must complete a mandatory Languages course from either [Aboriginal Languages K–10](#), [Auslan K–10](#), [Classical Languages K–10](#) or [Modern Languages K–10](#). The mandatory course can also be completed through Life Skills outcomes and content for [eligible](#) students.

Elective courses 7–10

The *Aboriginal Languages K–10 Syllabus* includes 8 elective courses:

- Aboriginal Languages – First Language 200-hour elective
- Aboriginal Languages – First Language 100-hour elective
- Aboriginal Languages – First Language Life Skills 200-hour elective
- Aboriginal Languages – First Language Life Skills 100-hour elective
- Aboriginal Languages – Language Revival 200-hour elective
- Aboriginal Languages – Language Revival 100-hour elective
- Aboriginal Languages – Language Revival Life Skills 200-hour elective
- Aboriginal Languages – Language Revival Life Skills 100-hour elective.

Focus of learning

The study of Aboriginal Languages enables students to communicate in the target language and learn about the vital role that Language has in the transmission of Aboriginal cultures. Students learn to communicate in an Aboriginal Language by interacting, responding and composing. They develop an understanding of the relationship between Language, Culture and identity, and the role of Language awareness and building.

What students learn

Students apply knowledge, understanding and skills by interacting, responding and composing in the target language. They also learn about the role of Language, Culture and identity and the building of Language awareness.

Students use the target Language to share, respond and compose information. They recognise the relationships between Languages and Cultures, and apply their knowledges, understanding and skills in the identification of available resources to maintain, revive and strengthen Aboriginal Languages.

Course requirements

Safety and risk management

Schools are required to ensure they follow [safety and risk management](#) in delivering the *Aboriginal Languages K–10 Syllabus*.

Life Skills

For Aboriginal Languages Life Skills:

- Students are required to demonstrate achievement of one or more Aboriginal Languages 7–10 Life Skills outcomes.
- Outcomes and content should be selected to meet the particular needs of individual students.
- The focus areas provide possible frameworks for addressing the Aboriginal Languages 7–10 Life Skills outcomes and content and are suggestions only. Teachers have the flexibility to select, group and sequence outcomes and content to meet the needs, strengths, goals, interests and prior learning of their students.

Course enrolment details

Information about [course entries](#) for the RoSA are available on [Assessment Certification Examination \(ACE\)](#).

Aboriginal Languages – Elective courses

Course name	200-hour	100-hour	200-hour Life Skills	100-hour Life Skills
Aboriginal Languages – First Language	753	754	757	758
Aboriginal Languages – Revival	740	741	755	756

Exclusions:

- 200-hour courses exclude 200-hour Life Skills courses
- 100-hour courses exclude 100-hour Life Skills courses

Students may not access Life Skills outcomes and other outcomes from the same subject.

RoSA information

Information about [curriculum requirements](#) for the RoSA are available on [Assessment Certification Examination \(ACE\)](#).

Rationale

The study of Aboriginal Languages enables students to communicate in the target language and learn about the vital role that language has in the transmission of Aboriginal cultures.

The study of Aboriginal Languages provides a unique opportunity to learn about and extend respect to Aboriginal Languages and cultures. Students learn about linguistic features and structures of the target language. Students develop conceptual understanding of the target language culture(s) that enable them to make meaning when responding to and composing texts. Students engage with Aboriginal Peoples' and Torres Strait Islander Peoples' histories and cultures, to become active participants in community life.

Aboriginal Languages and Torres Strait Islander Languages support the identities of Aboriginal Peoples and Torres Strait Islander Peoples. Aboriginal Peoples and Torres Strait Islander Peoples have the right to access their languages (*United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples* Resolution 61/295, adopted 13 September 2007).

The study of Aboriginal Languages enables Aboriginal students to maintain their connections to kin, culture, Country and Community. Aboriginal students are empowered to maintain a sense of identity, and to learn more about their communities. Aboriginal students have the right to learn their own language as future custodians and caretakers of their languages. Non-Aboriginal students are provided with the opportunity to develop knowledge and understanding of Aboriginal Peoples' languages, cultures and connection to Country, and the impact of colonisation histories.

The *Aboriginal Languages K–10 Syllabus* advocates the ongoing revitalisation and maintenance of Aboriginal Languages. As an exclusive and integral part of the K–10 curriculum, the maintenance, revitalisation, renewal or reclamation of Aboriginal Languages is of benefit to the sustainability of NSW Aboriginal linguistic and cultural diversity.

The delivery of the *Aboriginal Languages K–10 Syllabus* promotes a coherent and appropriately rigorous curriculum, which allows for developmental continuity. The study of Aboriginal Languages syllabuses could lead to an increased use of Aboriginal Languages in the home and community, as well as provide a foundation for further vocational and/or higher education pathways.

Aim

The study of Aboriginal Languages in K–10 enables students to communicate using an Aboriginal Language. Students reflect on and understand the nature and role of language, including the relationships between Aboriginal Languages, Countries and cultures. Students learn about the importance of maintenance and revival of Aboriginal Languages.

Assessment

The primary role of assessment is to establish where students are in their learning so that teaching can be differentiated and further learning progress can be monitored over time. It provides information that assists teachers to target their teaching at the point of student need. Assessment is most effective when it is an integral part of teaching and learning programs.

Assessment involves:

- establishing where students are in their learning
- ongoing monitoring
- formative and summative tasks
- providing feedback about student progress.

Common Grade Scale

Stage 1, Stage 2, Stage 3, Stage 4, Stage 5

The [common grade scale](#) can be used to report student achievement in both primary and junior secondary years in all NSW schools.

Course performance descriptors

Stage 5 – Year 10

Course performance descriptors provide holistic descriptions of typical achievement at different grade levels in a specific course. They are used to identify and report a student's level of achievement in a Board Developed Course at the end of Stage 5.

Grade A

A student performing at this grade typically:

- communicates consistently and effectively for a range of contexts, purposes and audiences
- manipulates the target language effectively to sustain interactions in a range of situations
- evaluates and responds to information and ideas in a range of moderately complex texts
- uses the linguistic structures, grammatical features and conventions of the target language to compose a range of well-structured and cohesive texts
- demonstrates a perceptive understanding of the interrelationships between language, culture and identity
- demonstrates an extensive understanding of language reclamation, revival and/or maintenance processes, protocols and programs

Grade B

A student performing at this grade typically:

- communicates clearly and consistently for a range of contexts, purposes and audiences
- manipulates the target language to sustain interactions in a range of situations
- evaluates and responds to information and ideas in a range of texts
- uses the linguistic structures, grammatical features and conventions of the target language to compose a range of well-structured texts
- demonstrates a well-reasoned understanding of the interrelationships between language, culture and identity
- demonstrates a thorough understanding of language reclamation, revival and/or maintenance processes, protocols and programs

Grade C

A student performing at this grade typically:

- communicates clearly and consistently for familiar contexts, purposes and audiences
- uses the target language to sustain interactions in familiar situations
- interprets and responds to information and ideas in a range of texts
- uses the linguistic structures, grammatical features and conventions of the target language to compose a range of texts
- demonstrates a sound understanding of the relationships between language, culture and identity
- demonstrates a sound understanding of language reclamation, revival and/or maintenance processes, protocols and programs

Grade D

A student performing at this grade typically:

- communicates with some clarity for familiar contexts, purposes and audiences
- uses the target language to interact in familiar situations
- identifies and responds to information in familiar texts
- uses the linguistic structures, grammatical features or conventions of the target language to compose basic texts
- demonstrates a basic understanding of connections between language, culture and identity
- demonstrates a basic understanding of language reclamation, revival and/or maintenance processes, protocols and programs

Grade E

A student performing at this grade typically:

- communicates with limited clarity
- uses some target language in familiar situations
- responds to some information in texts
- uses some aspects of the target language to compose basic texts
- demonstrates an awareness of language, culture and identity
- demonstrates an awareness of language reclamation, revival and/or maintenance processes, protocols or programs

Assessment of Life Skills outcomes

Stage 4, Stage 5

The syllabus outcomes and content form the basis of learning opportunities for students. Through the [collaborative curriculum planning process](#), teachers select specific Life Skills outcomes which are based on the needs, strengths, goals, interests and prior learning of each student. Students are required to demonstrate achievement of one or more Life Skills outcomes.

Assessment should provide opportunities for students to demonstrate achievement in relation to the selected outcomes. Assessment can occur in a range of situations or environments such as the school and wider community. Evidence of achievement can be based on:

- [formative](#) assessment opportunities
- [summative](#) assessment opportunities.

There is no requirement for formal assessment of Life Skills outcomes. Stage 6 Life Skills courses do not have external examinations or mandatory projects.

Ancient History 11–12 (2024)

Implementation from 2027

The new Ancient History 11–12 Syllabus (2024) is to be implemented from 2027 and will replace the [Ancient History Stage 6 Syllabus \(2017\)](#).

2025 and 2026

- Plan and prepare to teach the new syllabus

2027, Term 1

- Start teaching the new syllabuses for Year 11
- Start implementing the new Year 11 school-based assessment requirements
- Continue to teach the [Ancient History Stage 6 Syllabus \(2017\)](#) for Year 12

2027, Term 4

- Start teaching the new syllabuses for Year 12
- Start implementing the new Year 12 school-based assessment requirements

2028

- First HSC examination for the new syllabus

Overview

Syllabus overview

The *Ancient History 11–12 Syllabus* aligns with the *Ancient History Life Skills 11–12 Syllabus* to provide opportunities for integrated delivery.

Through [collaborative curriculum planning](#), it may be decided that [Life Skills outcomes and content](#) are the most appropriate option for some students with intellectual disability.

Organisation of Ancient History 11–12

Figure 1 shows the organisation of Ancient History 11–12.

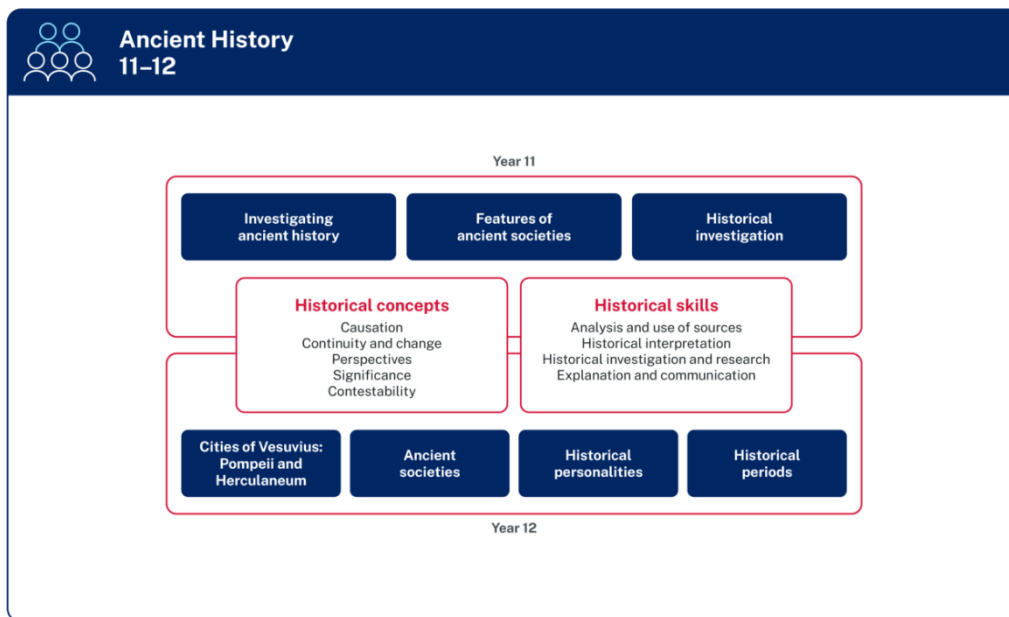


Figure 1: The organisation of Ancient History 11–12

Image long description: A list of historical concepts and historical skills sit in the middle of the diagram, each surrounded by a box. Historical concepts are: Causation; Continuity and change; Perspectives; Significance; and Contestability. Historical skills are: Analysis and use of sources; Historical interpretation; Historical investigation and research; and Explanation and communication. The syllabus is separated into 3 focus areas for Year 11, and 4 focus areas for Year 12. The focus areas for Year 11 are: Investigating ancient history; Features of ancient societies; and Historical investigation. The focus areas for Year 12 are: Cities of Vesuvius: Pompeii and Herculaneum; Ancient societies; Historical personalities; and Historical periods.

Protocols for collaborating with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Communities

NESA is committed to working in partnership with Aboriginal Communities and supporting teachers, schools and schooling sectors to improve educational outcomes for young people.

It is important to respect appropriate ways of interacting with Aboriginal Communities and Cultural material when teachers plan, program and implement Ancient History learning experiences that focus on Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Priorities.

Indigenous Cultural and Intellectual Property (ICIP) protocols need to be followed. Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples' ICIP protocols include Cultural Knowledges, Cultural Expression and Cultural Property and documentation of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples' Identities and lived experiences. It is important to recognise the diversity and complexity of different Cultural groups in NSW, as protocols may differ between local Aboriginal Communities.

Teachers should work in partnership with Elders, parents, Community members, Cultural Knowledge Holders or a local, regional or state Aboriginal Education Consultative Group. It is important to respect Elders and the roles of men and women. Local Aboriginal Peoples should be invited to share their Cultural Knowledges with students and staff when engaging with Aboriginal histories and Cultural Practices.

Course description

Ancient History 11–12 focuses on developing student understanding of the ancient past and how it was shaped by people and events. The course offers students opportunities to engage with written and physical sources from the past, developing students' analysis and reasoning skills.

What students learn

Through the study of Ancient History 11–12, students learn to:

- develop an understanding of historical causation and the ways in which human societies have changed over time
- develop an understanding of the variety of perspectives that have been and are held about the past
- develop skills in analysis and reasoning to make judgements about the significance of various people and events in the past and form their own conclusions about the nature of historical development
- construct logical and cogent historical arguments about the past, supported by evidence.

Course structure and requirements

Year 11 course structure and requirements

The Year 11 Ancient History course comprises a study of:

- 120 indicative hours across 3 focus areas.

Year 11 focus areas	Indicative hours
Investigating ancient history ▪ The nature of ancient history ▪ Case studies Each case study should be a minimum of 10 indicative hours.	60
Features of ancient societies	40 (minimum)
Historical investigation	20 (maximum)

Studies undertaken in the Year 11 course should be selected from a range of societies.

Content may be integrated across the 3 focus areas of the course in the development of a teaching and learning program.

Investigating ancient history

- The nature of ancient history
- Case studies

Students undertake:

- at least ONE option from The nature of ancient history, AND
- at least TWO case studies
- ONE case study **must** be from Egypt, Greece, Rome or Celtic Europe
- ONE case study **must** be from Australia, Asia, the Near East or the Americas.

The list in the Investigating ancient history – Case studies focus area of this syllabus provides case study options teachers may use.

Case studies are investigations into historical features, people, places, events and developments of the ancient world. They are oriented towards the problems and issues of investigating the past.

Case studies in the Year 11 course are intended to provide students with opportunities to:

- study the various ways in which historians and archaeologists investigate and construct the past, the types of questions they ask, the explanations they give and the issues they raise
- analyse and interpret archaeological and written sources
- generate hypotheses and weigh up contemporary theories and explanations on the basis of the available evidence.

Case studies can provide a historical context in which students learn about relevant methods and issues.

Case studies must not overlap with or duplicate significantly any option to be attempted in the Year 12 Ancient History or History Extension courses.

Features of ancient societies

Students study at least TWO ancient societies through an investigation of:

- a different key feature for each society, OR
- one key feature across the societies selected.

A range of possible options is provided in the Features of ancient societies focus area of this syllabus.

Learning in the focus area of Features of ancient societies is concerned with seeking explanations of the 'how' and 'why' questions of history. This includes an interpretation of the evidence for how people lived in the past and why they may have lived that way. This focus area provides students with opportunities to develop an understanding of:

- the nature, range and limitations of the available sources
- the social history of a people through an investigation of the remains of their material culture
- significant developments, forces or individuals that may have shaped the selected feature(s).

Options selected must not overlap with or duplicate significantly any option to be attempted in the Year 12 Ancient History or History Extension courses.

Historical investigation

The Historical investigation is designed to further develop relevant investigative, research and communication skills. The investigation may be undertaken as a standalone study or integrated into any other focus area in the Year 11 course. The investigation should extend a particular area of individual student or group interest. It may be conducted individually or collaboratively.

The investigation must not overlap with or duplicate significantly any option to be attempted in the Year 12 Ancient History or History Extension courses.

Historical concepts and skills

The historical concepts and skills content is to be integrated throughout the course. The various studies and options provide the contexts through which concepts and skills are to be developed. These help guide students when engaging in historical analysis and argument.

Year 12 course structure and requirements

The Year 12 Ancient History course comprises a study of:

- 120 indicative hours across 4 focus areas

- Core study: Cities of Vesuvius – Pompeii and Herculaneum
- ONE Ancient societies option
- ONE Historical personalities option
- ONE Historical periods option.

Year 12 focus areas	Indicative hours
Core study: Cities of Vesuvius – Pompeii and Herculaneum	30
Ancient societies	30
Historical personalities	30
Historical periods	30

The Year 12 course requires study from at least TWO of the following areas:

- Egypt
- Near East
- China
- Greece
- Rome.

The Core study: Cities of Vesuvius – Pompeii and Herculaneum is a Roman study.

Options in the Year 12 course contain a Context content group. This content group should be taught in a maximum of 3 hours.

Historical concepts and skills

The historical concepts and skills content is to be integrated throughout the course. The options provide the contexts through which concepts and skills are to be developed. These help guide students when engaging in historical analysis and argument.

Safety and risk management

Schools are required to ensure they follow [safety and risk management](#) in delivering the *Ancient History 11–12 Syllabus*.

Course enrolment details

Ancient History Year 11

- Course number: 11020
- Course hours: 120
- Course units: 2
- Enrolment type: Elective
- Endorsement type: Board developed

Exclusions

- Ancient History Life Skills (Year 11, 2 units): 17540
- Human Society and its Environment Life Skills (Year 11, 2 units): 16699*

* Where Ancient History Life Skills is undertaken in the course.

Prerequisites

- Nil

Corequisites

- Nil

Ancient History Year 12

- Course number: 15020
- Course hours: 120
- Course units: 2
- Enrolment type: Elective
- Endorsement type: Board developed

Exclusions

- Ancient History Life Skills (Year 12, 2 units): 17540
- Human Society and its Environment Life Skills (Year 12, 2 units): 16699*

* Where Ancient History Life Skills is undertaken in the course.

Prerequisites

- Ancient History (Year 11, 2 units): 11020

Corequisites

- Nil

HSC information

Information about [curriculum requirements](#) for the HSC are available on [Assessment Certification Examination \(ACE\)](#).

Rationale

The study of Ancient History engages students in an investigation of life in early societies based on the analysis and interpretation of physical and written sources. It stimulates students' curiosity and imagination and enriches their appreciation of humanity and its ancient past. It shows how the world and its people have changed, and how significant legacies have survived into the present. Ancient History is also concerned with the possible motivations and actions of individuals and groups, and how they shaped the political, social and cultural landscapes of the ancient world. Investigation of the ancient past develops students' appreciation of the diversity of ancient societies, including Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples' Cultures, which are the oldest living, continuous cultures in the world.

The study of Ancient History has contemporary relevance. Students of Ancient History have the opportunity to acquire the skills to analyse and challenge accepted theories and interpretations about the ancient world, especially as new evidence and technologies emerge. This study raises important ethical issues associated with ownership, administration and conservation of the cultural past. It requires students to consider how the ancient past has been used or misused by individuals and groups through time, and how that past has been represented in forms such as literature, film and museum displays. Through analysis, students consider how the ancient past continues to shape the present, and how the present shapes our view of the past.

The study of Ancient History requires students to apply historical concepts, to explore historical issues and to pose critical questions while investigating the ancient world. It draws on methods used by historians and archaeologists to analyse sources from the past and to communicate their findings and interpretations. In Ancient History, students are introduced to the complexities of reconstructing the past, often by using fragmentary evidence from a range of literary, epigraphic and archaeological sources. As they do so, students communicate increasingly perceptive, sustained and coherent historical arguments.

The Ancient History syllabus is designed to enhance the development of critical and reflective thinking skills which are essential for effective participation in further learning, including tertiary study, work and the broader community. It offers students the opportunity to develop skills of analysis, reasoning, synthesis and effective communication, which can be used in post-school contexts.

Aim

The study of Ancient History in Years 11–12 enables students to develop knowledge and understanding of the ancient world and the skills of critical analysis. It provides the opportunity to acquire the knowledge, values and attitudes essential for an appreciation of the diverse people, ideas and forces that shaped the ancient past. By undertaking the course, students develop a lifelong interest in the study of history and prepare for active and informed citizenship in the contemporary world.

Table of outcomes

Year 11	Year 12
AH-11-01 explains continuity and change in the ancient world	AH-12-01 analyses continuity and change in the ancient world
AH-11-02 proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments	AH-12-02 proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments
AH-11-03 explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past	AH-12-03 assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past
AH-11-04 accounts for the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context	AH-12-04 analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context
AH-11-05 analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument	AH-12-05 evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument
AH-11-06 explains differing interpretations and representations of the past	AH-12-06 evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past
AH-11-07 communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts	AH-12-07 communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts
AH-11-08 plans and conducts historical investigations and presents conclusions, using evidence from a range of sources	

Outcomes and content for Year 11

Historical concepts and skills 11–12

Content

The following skills, which incorporate the concepts of [causation](#), [continuity and change](#), [perspectives](#), [significance](#) and [contestability](#), are to be integrated with the content of the course.

Analysis and use of sources

- Explain the meaning and value of [sources](#) for a [historical inquiry](#)
- Analyse sources to identify and account for the different perspectives of individuals and groups in the past
- Analyse and synthesise [evidence](#) from different types of sources to develop reasoned claims
- Identify and analyse problems relating to sources in the investigation of the past

Historical interpretation

- Analyse the extent and nature of continuity and change over time
- Identify and analyse the varying causes and effects of events and developments to construct historical arguments
- Form judgements about historical significance, recognising that significance may be attributed for different purposes
- Analyse and evaluate contested [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of the past

Historical investigation and research

- Frame questions to guide historical inquiry and develop a coherent research plan
- Use evidence from a range of sources to inform investigation and research
- Acknowledge sources appropriately

Explanation and communication

- Develop texts, particularly historical accounts and arguments, supported by relevant evidence from sources
- Communicate historical understanding, using historical knowledge, [terms](#) and [concepts](#), in forms appropriate to the purpose and audience

Investigating ancient history – The nature of ancient history

Students discuss contemporary methods and issues involved in the investigation of [ancient](#) history through a study of at least ONE of the following focus area options:

- The investigation of ancient sites and [sources](#)
- The [representation](#) of the ancient past
- Conservation and [reconstruction](#) of ancient sites
- Cultural [heritage](#) and the role of museums
- The treatment and display of human remains.

The content may be taught as a standalone unit or teachers may develop an integrated study incorporating selected elements of 2 or more of the above 5 options. Content may also be integrated into Case studies, Features of ancient societies and the Historical investigation.

The investigation of ancient sites and sources

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Investigation

- The changing nature of archaeological excavation, recording techniques and methods of analysis

Example(s):

Site surveys using radar, excavation, dating methods, forensic examination, DNA analysis.

- Problems of authenticity and methods of authentication
- Challenges associated with reconstructing the past using archaeological [sources](#)

Example(s):

Understanding ancient customs and religious beliefs, gaps in the evidence, issues of provenance.

- The value and limitations of [ancient](#) texts, inscriptions, petroglyphs and iconography to an understanding of the ancient past

The representation of the ancient past

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Investigation

- The [representation](#) of the [ancient](#) past in the [modern](#) world

Example(s):

In art, myths and legends, memorials, museums, the media, film, documentaries, multimedia, interactive media.

- The various ways a person, site, society or event from the ancient past, including ancient Australia, has been represented over time
- The reasons for the differing representations
- An evaluation of the representations using available [sources](#)

Conservation and reconstruction of ancient sites

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Investigation

- The nature of the site(s), and the condition and extent of the remains
- Issues of conservation and management of the site(s), including factors that threaten the integrity or survival of the [ancient](#) site

Example(s):

Environmental factors, war, deliberate destruction, pillaging, poverty, tourism.

- The effectiveness of methods used to conserve and/or reconstruct the site(s), including relevant national or international charters or conventions

Example(s):

UNESCO, international efforts to protect ancient sites of World Heritage significance.

- The [reconstruction](#) of the ancient site(s), including restoration of a site to its original form and digital reconstructions

Cultural heritage and the role of museums

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Investigation

- The nature and impact of the looting and illegal trade of antiquities on cultural [heritage](#), including Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander antiquities
- The role of museums in acquiring, storing and exhibiting artefacts and cultural materials

Example(s):

The Metropolitan Museum of Art, the British Museum, Pitt Rivers Museum, the Louvre, Pergamon Museum.

- Cultural property and the arguments for and against repatriation

Example(s):

Cultural value, connection to culture, illegal dispossession, ability to conserve, global access.

- The contributions of museums to our understanding of [ancient](#) ways of life and the question of whose past is represented in displays and exhibitions

The treatment and display of human remains

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Investigation

- The condition of the human remains and how they were preserved, discovered, exhumed and/or removed
- The methods and results of scientific analysis and [modern](#) preservation of the remains
- The [significance](#) of the human remains in contributing to an understanding of the life and times in which they lived
- The ethical issues relevant to the treatment, display, ownership and repatriation of the remains, including Aboriginal human remains

Example(s):

The use of invasive methods of scientific analysis, respectful display and acknowledgement of cultural heritage.

Investigating ancient history – Case studies

Students study at least TWO case studies, choosing ONE from List A and ONE from List B. The studies may incorporate methods and issues involved in investigating the [ancient](#) past, as relevant.

Teachers may develop their own case studies. These may be designed to provide a context for options selected in the Year 12 course. However, case studies must not overlap with or duplicate significantly any option to be attempted in the Year 12 Ancient History or History Extension courses. Teacher-developed case studies must follow the geographical division indicated in Lists A and B.

List A: Case studies from Egypt, Greece, Rome and Celtic Europe

- List A: Old Kingdom Egypt
- List A: Tutankhamun's tomb
- List A: Deir el-Medina
- List A: Alexandria
- List A: Thera
- List A: Troy
- List A: The Roman games
- List A: The Celts
- List A: Boudicca

List B: Case studies from Australia, Asia, the Near East and the Americas

- List B: Ancient Australia
- List B: The Shang dynasty
- List B: Ashoka
- List B: Nineveh
- List B: Persepolis
- List B: Civilisations of the river – Mesopotamia and the Indus Valley
- List B: Masada
- List B: Palmyra and the Silk Road
- List B: Teotihuacan

Other possible case studies related to List A could include:

- the Valley of the Queens
- Mycenae
- Greek drama
- the Etruscans
- the impact of expansion on Rome
- Tiberius Gracchus
- the city of Rome
- Roman Britain.

Other possible case studies related to List B could include:

- Jericho
- Lachish
- the Akkadian Empire
- Carthage
- Hannibal and the Punic Wars
- the Battle of Red Cliffs
- the Moche

- the early Maya.

Teacher-developed case studies must include the aspects of study identified in the following framework:

- the geographical and historical context
- the range and issues of [sources](#)
- the historical features, people, places, events and developments of the ancient world selected for study
- differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#).

List A: Old Kingdom Egypt

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- The natural features, resources and key sites of Old Kingdom Egypt, such as Memphis, cemeteries of Saqqara, Giza and Dahshur
- An overview of the Old Kingdom period, including its establishment

The range and issues of sources

- Early excavations and archaeological discoveries
- Written [sources](#), such as the Narmer Palette and the Pyramid Texts
- Archaeological sources, such as royal and noble tombs and the Giza pyramid complexes of Dynasty IV

Features of Old Kingdom Egypt

- The roles and images of the king, the concepts of Ma'at and Isfet, the roles of the official class and the roles of women
- Trade, commerce, industries and employment, and the [significance](#) of the Nile
- Cults of Re and Osiris, cultural beliefs and practices, the sciences and literature
- The nature of funerary customs, royal tombs and tombs of the nobility
- The reasons for the collapse of Old Kingdom Egypt

- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of Old Kingdom Egypt

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the reasons for the collapse, such as internal divisions or changes in climate; 'orientalist' representations of Old Kingdom Egypt.

List A: Tutankhamun's tomb

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- The natural features, resources and key sites of New Kingdom Egypt, such as Thebes and the Valley of the Kings
- An overview of New Kingdom Egypt, the religious crisis and mystery of the pharaonic line at the time of Tutankhamun

The range and issues of sources

- The discovery and excavation of the tomb by Howard Carter
- The structure and key features of Tutankhamun's tomb
- Tomb paintings, decoration, burial goods and artefacts found in the tomb

Burial customs at the time of Tutankhamun

- The [evidence](#) for funerary beliefs and practices
- The nature of mummification

Analysis of the human remains

- The condition of the human remains found in the tomb
- The methods and results of scientific and forensic analysis
- 21st-century archaeology and ethical issues in the preservation and examination of Tutankhamun's remains
- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of Tutankhamun

Example(s):

Differing reconstructions of Tutankhamun; theories about Tutankhamun's cause of death; the Grand Egyptian Museum displays.

List A: Deir el-Medina

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- The location and purpose of Deir el-Medina
- The role of Amenhotep I and Ahmose-Nefertari in its foundation

The range and issues of sources

- The work of [modern](#) Egyptologists, including Auguste Mariette, Gaston Maspero, Ernesto Schiaparelli, Bernard Bruyère and Jaroslav Černý
- Archaeological and written [sources](#)

Features of life at Deir el-Medina

- Social structure, occupations, commerce and trade
- The roles and images of women in the written and archaeological record
- The nature of everyday life
- Religious beliefs and practices
- The construction of royal and non-royal tombs, such as the those of Thutmose III, Seti I, Sennedjem, Kha and Meryt
- Burial beliefs and practices
- The workers' strike and tomb robberies
- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of Deir el-Medina

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the use of rooms in houses and the role of women; representations of the 'Cult of Domesticity' in Deir el-Medina.

List A: Alexandria

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- Location, topography and town planning
- Historical overview, including Alexander the Great and the foundation of the city, the city under the Ptolemies and the impact of Rome

The range and issues of sources

- Early excavations and underwater archaeological discoveries
- The nature of the available written and archaeological [sources](#)
- Architectural features, such as the Pharos lighthouse, the Serapeum and the Great Harbour

Features of society in Alexandria

- The nature of society, including the Greek elite, Egyptians, Jews and other immigrants
- The roles and privileges of citizens
- Significant individuals, such as Ptolemy I Soter, Cleopatra VII, Claudius Ptolemy, Eratosthenes and Hypatia
- Features of cultural life, such as religious beliefs and practices, the Library of Alexandria, and Hellenistic learning and philosophy
- Economic life, including trade, commerce, industries and occupations
- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of Alexandria

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of relations between pagans, Jews and Christians in the city; representations of Alexandria in film.

List A: Thera

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- The geographical location and topography of Thera
- The historical context of the region in the Bronze Age

The range and issues of sources

- Discoveries and excavations at Thera, including the work of Spyridon Marinatos and Christos Doumas
- The [interpretation](#) of the wall paintings at Akrotiri, such as the Spring Fresco, the Young Boxers, the Naval Campaign Fresco and the Fisherman Fresco
- The architecture and pottery of Akrotiri

Features of life at Thera

- The [evidence](#) for everyday life
- The [significance](#) of the site as a trading or religious settlement
- The evidence of Thera's relationship to the Minoan culture on Crete
- The dating of the Thera eruption and the extent of its impact on the Aegean world
- Differing interpretations and [representations](#) of Thera

Example(s):

Arguments for the relevance of Plato's *Timaeus* and *Critias* for the study of Thera and Crete; theories about the role of the eruption in ending Minoan culture.

List A: Troy

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- An overview of the Bronze Age world, including major cultural sites, social, economic, political and religious structures
- The strategic location of Troy
- The Trojan legends, including Greek gods, Homer and the Epic Cycle

The range and issues of sources

- The discovery and excavation of Troy, including Frank Calvert, Heinrich Schliemann, Wilhelm Dörpfeld, Carl Blegen and Manfred Korfmann
- Heinrich Schliemann's excavations at Mycenae
- Written [sources](#), such as the Linear B tablets from Pylos, Homer's *Iliad*, Euripides's *The Trojan Women* and the Hittite diplomatic archive
- Archaeological sources

The history of Troy and the Trojan War

- [Evidence](#) for different layers of Troy in the archaeological record
- The role and status of women, including the treatment of Helen, the fate of Trojan and Greek women, and the role of goddesses
- The evidence for Homer's Troy and the Trojan War
- The legacy of the Trojan War in the [ancient](#) world

Example(s):

The decline of Mycenae, mythology in Greek art and literature, Aeneas and the foundation of Rome.

- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of Troy and the Trojan War

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the historicity of the Trojan War; representations of the Trojan War in modern film.

List A: The Roman games

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- The origins of the Roman games
- The development and location of amphitheatres in the Roman world

The range and issues of sources

- Archaeological [evidence](#), such as the Flavian Amphitheatre, Circus Maximus and the Gladiator Mosaic
- Written [sources](#), such as epigraphic sources, Juvenal, Martial and Seneca

The nature of the Roman games

- Spectacles, including naval recreations, chariot races and beast hunts
- The types of gladiators and their fighting techniques
- The depictions and status of gladiators in Roman culture
- Victims of the games
- The social and political role of the Roman games

Example(s):

The voice of the people, accusations of decadence, the image of the emperor, visibility of the Senate, 'bread and circuses', the might of Rome.

- The decline of the Roman games
- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of the Roman games

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the morality of the Roman games; representations of the Roman games in modern film.

List A: The Celts

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- Urnfield 1200–600 BCE, Hallstatt 700–500 BCE, La Tène 500 BCE–100 CE and the development of Celtic culture across Europe

The range and issues of sources

- Archaeological [sources](#), such as human remains, Castro de Viladonga, Heuneburg, Hochdorf Grave, Maiden Castle and Newgrange
- Written sources, such as Appian, Caesar, Diodorus Siculus, Livy, Tacitus, Polybius and Strabo

Features of Celtic life

- The range and nature of settlement across Celtic Europe
- Religious beliefs and practices, including Druidism, burial sanctuaries and cemeteries
- Everyday life, including social organisation, technology, art and culture
- Weapons and warfare, and the nature of contact with the Romans
- The role of significant individuals, such as Cassivellaunus, Commius and Vercingetorix
- The decline of the Celts
- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of the Celts

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the role of druids in Celtic society; representations of Celtic history and culture during the Celtic Revival.

List A: Boudicca

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- The background of the Celts, including the tribal organisation of Britain, and the identification and location of the Iceni
- An overview of the Roman conquest of Britain and the nature of Romanisation
- The organisation of Roman Britain, including administration, the settlement of veterans and the imperial cult

The range and issues of sources

- Archaeological [sources](#), such as [evidence](#) for Iceni culture and the destruction of Camulodunum and Londinium
- Written sources, including Tacitus and Cassius Dio on Prasutagus, Boudicca and the revolt

Boudicca's conflict with Rome

- The reasons for the revolt

Example(s):

The discontent of Boudicca and the Iceni, the Trinovantes and other Celts; the role of Decianus Catus.

- The nature of the campaign, including Celtic fighting methods and Roman weapons and tactics
- The role of Boudicca and Suetonius Paulinus
- The aftermath of the revolt and consequences for the Celts and Romans
- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of Boudicca

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of Boudicca's relationship with the Romans; representations of Boudicca in the Victorian period.

List B: Ancient Australia

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- The scope and [diversity](#) of [Aboriginal](#) Cultures and [Language groups](#) across Australia
- The geographical and Cultural context of one or more sites

The range and issues of sources

- Archaeological [sources](#), such as hunting tools, grinding stones, shell middens, scar trees, petroglyphs, iconography and human remains
- Oral history, including [Elder](#) and Community Knowledges and custodial care of the site(s)
- The [Dreaming](#) and how site(s) were created

The archaeology of ancient Australia

- Dating technologies used on the site(s) and the conclusions drawn
- The Cultural and spiritual [significance](#) of the site(s) for Aboriginal Peoples
- Differing views on conservation relating to the site(s)
- The principles of [Indigenous Cultural and Intellectual Property \(ICIP\)](#) relevant to the site(s)

Example(s):

ICIP protocols include Cultural Knowledges, Cultural Practices and Cultural Property.

- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of [ancient](#) Australia

List B: The Shang dynasty

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- The rise of the Shang and the geographical extent of the Shang state

The range and issues of sources

- Archaeological [sources](#), such as royal tombs and bronze artefacts
- The [significance](#) of Anyang, including archaeological methods employed at the site, the royal cemetery and discovery of the tomb of Lady Fu Hao
- Written sources, such as oracle bones

The nature of the Shang dynasty

- The structure of the Shang state, including the role of the king, the role of the military and the status of women
- Prominent individuals, including Emperor Wu Ding and Lady Fu Hao
- Features of the Shang society, such as the system of writing, the calendar, bronze craftsmanship, and religion, including ancestor worship and human sacrifice
- The reasons for the fall of the Shang dynasty
- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of the Shang dynasty

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the origins of the Shang dynasty; representations of Shang ancestor worship in later dynasties.

List B: Ashoka

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- An overview of the Mauryan Empire and Chandragupta Maurya, features of the administration, economy and religion

The range and issues of sources

- Archaeological [sources](#), such as the Pillars of Ashoka, the Great Stupa at Sanchi, the Lion Capital of Ashoka (Ashokmudra), and the 80-pillar hypostyle hall at Kumhrar
- Written sources, including the Edicts of Ashoka, the *Ashokavadana* and the *Mahāvamsa*

The role and contribution of Ashoka

- Ashoka's family background, problems with succession, early reign and expansion of the empire
- The Battle of Kalinga, including the aims, outcome and impact on Ashoka
- The extent and impact of Ashoka's pacifism
- Trade and the spread of Buddhism
- Ashoka's approaches to religion and administration
- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of Ashoka

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of Ashoka's relationship to Buddhism; the role of Ashoka's pacifism in the decline and fall of the Mauryan Empire.

List B: Nineveh

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- An overview of the early Assyrian Empire from Tiglath-Pileser I to Sennacherib and the early capital cities of Nimrud and Khorsabad
- Location of the site of Nineveh

The range and issues of sources

- The discovery of Nineveh and the nature of archaeological excavation over time
- Archaeological [sources](#), such as the palaces of Ashurnasirpal II, Sennacherib and Ashurbanipal; the temples of Nabu and Ishtar; the Royal Library of Ashurbanipal; gardens; wall reliefs

The history of Nineveh

- The layout and features of the city of Nineveh
- Design and ornamentation of the Neo-Assyrian period
- The role of Nineveh as a centre of Assyrian power
- The nature of contact with other peoples
- Debate over the destruction of Nineveh
- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of Nineveh

Example(s):

Biblical interpretations; representations in 19th-century art and poetry.

List B: Persepolis

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- An overview of the Persian Empire from Cyrus the Great to Darius I and the early capital cities of Ecbatana and Pasargadae
- The [significance](#) of the site's geographical location

The range and issues of sources

- The discovery of Persepolis and the nature of archaeological excavation over time
- Archaeological [sources](#), such as the Apadana, the Hall of a Hundred Columns (Throne Hall), glazed brick panels and wall reliefs at the site

The history of Persepolis

- The layout and features of the city of Persepolis
- The design and ornamentation of the Achaemenid period
- The [evidence](#) for the role of Persepolis as a centre of Persian power
- Debate over the role of Alexander the Great in the destruction of Persepolis
- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of Persepolis

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the destruction of Persepolis; representations of Persepolis under the Pahlavi dynasty.

List B: Civilisations of the river – Mesopotamia and the Indus Valley

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- The question of where, when and why the earliest-settled societies developed in various places across the world

The range and issues of sources

- The discovery and excavation of sites that reveal [evidence](#) of early settlement
- The nature and challenges of evidence in art, iconography, writing, pottery and tools

Features of civilisations of the river

- The Indus Valley Civilisation/Harappan culture and the sites of Mohenjo-daro and Harappa
- Ur and the Sumerian Early Dynastic period
- The defining characteristics of early societies, such as farming, social classes, writing, religion, rule of law, art, architecture and trade
- The nature and scope of contact with other peoples
- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of Mesopotamia and the Indus Valley

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the 'Death Pits' of Ur; representations of the Indus Valley Civilisation in modern Pakistan.

List B: Masada

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- An overview of the location and geographical features of Masada
- The Roman control of Judaea and the organisation of the province
- The problems between the Jews and the Romans leading to the outbreak of war

The range and issues of sources

- Archaeological finds, the defences of Masada and the site of the Roman camp
- The account of Flavius Josephus in *The Jewish War* and its accuracy

The occupation and siege of Masada

- The occupation of Masada by Jewish rebels
- The course of the siege of Masada and the role of Flavius Silva and Eleazar ben Ya'ir
- The fall of Masada and the aftermath
- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of Masada

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the accuracy of Josephus on the siege of Masada; representations of Masada in the formation of national identity in Israel.

List B: Palmyra and the Silk Road

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- The location of the site of Palmyra
- The development of the city from an agricultural village into the hub of the Silk Road
- The [significance](#) of the Silk Road and the nature of trade

The range and issues of sources

- Archaeological [sources](#), such as the Great Colonnade, the Tariff Court, the Temple of Bel, the Temple of Baalshamin, tombs, the Theatre, coinage and roads
- Written sources and inscriptions, such as the *Historia Augusta* and the Palmyrene Tax Tariff

The history of Palmyra

- Palmyra's role as a 'caravan city' on the east–west trade route and meeting place for various [cultures](#)
- Economic and cultural exchange in Palmyra, the collection of taxes and trade links with India and China
- The influence of Eastern and Western traditions on language, art, architecture and religion in Palmyra
- Relations between Palmyra and Rome, including the influence of Queen Zenobia
- The end of Zenobia's reign and the decline of Palmyra
- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of Palmyra and the Silk Road

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the nature of Palmyrene culture as 'Eastern' or 'Western'; representations of Zenobia in early modern art.

List B: Teotihuacan

Outcomes

A student:

- explains continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-11-01**
- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

The geographical and historical context

- The location and geographical features of the Teotihuacan Valley, including the urban and rural inhabitants, chinampas and caves
- The stages and nature of occupation: Maya, Mixtec, Zapotec and the arrival of the Mexica

The range and issues of sources

- Archaeological [sources](#), such as murals, glyphs, funerary masks, human and animal remains
- Features of the city, such as barrios and apartment compounds, the Pyramids of the Sun and Moon, the Temple of the Feathered Serpent and the Avenue of the Dead

The history of Teotihuacan

- The [significance](#) of the Teotihuacan Mapping Project
- The role of religion, including deities, ritual sacrifice and burials
- Everyday life, including social classes and economic activity
- Contact with other peoples, including trade and the [diversity](#) of the inhabitants
- Theories about the collapse of Teotihuacan, such as natural disaster, internal rebellion or external attack
- Differing [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of Teotihuacan

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the uses of the Temple of the Feathered Serpent; representations of Teotihuacan in modern Mexico.

Features of ancient societies

Outcomes

A student:

- proposes ideas about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-11-02**
- explains the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-11-03**
- accounts for the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-11-04**
- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-11

Content

Students study TWO [ancient](#) societies through an investigation of:

- a different key feature for each society, OR
- one key feature across the societies selected.

An appropriate historical period should be identified. The key feature(s) should be appropriate for the ancient society or societies selected.

The ancient societies and key features are to be drawn from the following:

Ancient societies

- Egypt
- Phoenicia
- Assyria
- Persia
- Israel
- Mycenae
- Greece
- Etruria
- Carthage
- Rome
- Celtic Europe
- India
- China

Key features

- Women
- Slavery
- Art and architecture
- Weapons and warfare
- Death and funerary customs
- Power and image
- Trade and cultural contact

The options chosen must not overlap with or duplicate significantly any option to be attempted for the Year 12 Ancient History or History Extension courses.

Women

- The nature, range and limitations of [sources](#) about women
- Attitudes towards women as revealed through the sources
- Depictions of gender – masculinity and femininity in the historical record and how they compare
- The role of women in the family and in the economy
- The reasons for the status and role of women in religious and political life
- The role and [significance](#) of at least ONE influential woman

Slavery

- The nature, range and limitations of sources about slavery and enslaved people
- [Evidence](#) of the origins and extent of slavery
- Composition of enslaved people – men, women and children, and their occupations
- Attitudes to slavery, the status of enslaved people and their relationship with their masters
- The treatment of enslaved people and their importance to the economy
- Significant events, including at least ONE example of resistance and revolts

Art and architecture

- The nature, range and limitations of sources about art and architecture
- The main features, materials, purpose and function of various forms of architecture
- Themes and styles of art
- [Representation](#) and use of art and architecture by various groups, including non-elites
- The role and significance of at least ONE example of art and architecture
- Evidence of the spread of particular forms of art and architecture in the ancient world

Weapons and warfare

- The nature, range and limitations of sources about weapons and warfare
- The structure and role of armies and/or navies and changes in forms of weapons and military tactics
- The experiences of soldiers, including training and conditions of service
- The significance of the military in society
- The significance of the strategy and tactics of at least ONE key military encounter
- The impact of warfare and conquest on the conquerors and conquered

Death and funerary customs

- The nature, range and limitations of sources about beliefs, rituals and funerary practices
- The key beliefs and rituals for a range of groups in the society
- The influence and significance of beliefs and rituals
- Attitudes to and beliefs about death, including the concept of an afterlife
- Funerary practices, such as forms of burial, burial sites and ceremonies
- A study of at least ONE significant site and source relating to death and funerary practices

Power and image

- The nature, range and limitations of sources about authority figures and their image
- The range of key authority figures in the society
- The images of authority figures as revealed through a range of sources
- The roles and influence of authority figures

- The ruling elite, the nature of their position in society and the importance of the military in political life
- The reputation, activities and significance of at least ONE key authority figure

Trade and cultural contact

- The nature, range and limitations of sources about trade and cultural contact between ancient societies
- The motivations for trade, the evidence for trade routes and the types of goods that were traded
- The impact of trade on society
- Awareness of and attitudes towards other cultures
- The nature and impact of cultural contact between ancient societies
- A study of at least ONE significant site relating to trade, such as a shipwreck or port

Historical investigation

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-11-05**
- explains differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-11-06**
- communicates historical understanding, applying historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-11-07**
- plans and conducts historical investigations and presents conclusions, using evidence from a range of sources **AH-11-08**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11, AH-LS-12

Content

The Historical investigation is designed to provide opportunities for all students to develop the historical skills that are the core of the [historical inquiry](#) process. The investigation should extend a particular area of individual student or group interest and be developed to meet students' learning needs. The investigation can be integrated into any focus area of the Year 11 course. The historical [concepts](#) and skills content is to be integrated as appropriate.

The investigation must not overlap with or duplicate significantly any option to be attempted in the Year 12 Ancient History or History Extension courses.

The topic should be developed from one or more of the following areas:

- aspects of an [ancient](#) society as revealed through [sources](#)
- the causes and impacts of a historical event
- the role of a significant historical individual
- the significance of a historical development
- tracing the development of an aspect of the ancient past over time through a thematic approach
- the analysis of a historical debate, controversy or [representation](#) of the past
- the contribution of a historical site or archaeological evidence to our understanding of the past
- an [interpretation](#) or representation of an individual, group or event.

The process of historical investigation

- Formulate historical questions and hypotheses relevant to the investigation
- Identify and analyse sources to develop a view about a historical issue
- Develop and/or examine historical interpretations
- Synthesise [evidence](#) and information from a range of sources to develop and support a reasoned historical account or argument
- Use historical [terms](#) and concepts appropriately
- Present and communicate the findings of a historical investigation using appropriate and well-structured forms

Outcomes and content for Year 12

Historical concepts and skills 11–12

Content

The following skills, which incorporate the concepts of [causation](#), [continuity and change](#), [perspectives](#), [significance](#) and [contestability](#), are to be integrated with the content of the course.

Analysis and use of sources

- Explain the meaning and value of [sources](#) for a [historical inquiry](#)
- Analyse sources to identify and account for the different perspectives of individuals and groups in the past
- Analyse and synthesise [evidence](#) from different types of sources to develop reasoned claims
- Identify and analyse problems relating to sources in the investigation of the past

Historical interpretation

- Analyse the extent and nature of continuity and change over time
- Identify and analyse the varying causes and effects of events and developments to construct historical arguments
- Form judgements about historical significance, recognising that significance may be attributed for different purposes
- Analyse and evaluate contested [interpretations](#) and [representations](#) of the past

Historical investigation and research

- Frame questions to guide historical inquiry and develop a coherent research plan
- Use evidence from a range of sources to inform investigation and research
- Acknowledge sources appropriately

Explanation and communication

- Develop texts, particularly historical accounts and arguments, supported by relevant evidence from sources
- Communicate historical understanding, using historical knowledge, [terms](#) and [concepts](#), in forms appropriate to the purpose and audience

Core study: Cities of Vesuvius – Pompeii and Herculaneum

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Through an analysis of archaeological and written [sources](#), students investigate features of life in the cities of Pompeii and Herculaneum. They explore archaeological practices of the 20th and 21st centuries and related contemporary issues.

In investigating content in the Source analysis content group, students analyse and interpret a range of sources as [evidence](#) for life in Pompeii and Herculaneum.

The historical [concepts](#) and skills content is to be integrated as appropriate.

Context

- The geographical setting and natural features of Campania
- The impact of the eruption of 79 CE on Pompeii and Herculaneum

Source analysis: interpreting the evidence for life in Pompeii and Herculaneum

- The nature, range, value and limitations of sources about Pompeii and Herculaneum, including art, buildings, organic remains and writing

Example(s):

Art: wall paintings, statues, mosaics; buildings: public and private, streetscapes; organic remains: animal, human, plant; writing: ancient writers, official inscriptions, graffiti.

- Social organisation, including men, women, freedmen, freedwomen and enslaved people
- Local political life, including magistrates and elections
- Economic activities, including commerce, industries and occupations
- Features and functions of houses
- Leisure activities, including entertainment and baths
- Health, including diet, water supply and sanitation
- Public and private religion

Archaeology at Pompeii and Herculaneum

- The practices and challenges of excavation and conservation at the sites in the 20th and 21st centuries
- Changing [interpretations](#) of the sites, including the contribution of recent technology
- 21st-century archaeological issues, including the ethics of the study of human remains and the impact of tourism

Ancient societies

Students investigate key features of ONE [ancient](#) society through a range of archaeological and written [sources](#) and relevant historiographical issues.

The historical [concepts](#) and skills content is to be integrated as appropriate.

Students study key features and issues of the history of ONE of the following:

- New Kingdom Egypt to the death of Amenhotep III
- New Kingdom Egypt during the Ramesside period
- Israel from Solomon to the fall of Samaria
- Persia in the time of Darius and Xerxes
- China during the Han dynasty
- Minoan Crete in the Bronze Age
- Sparta to the Battle of Leuctra 371 BCE
- Athens in the time of Pericles.

New Kingdom Egypt to the death of Amenhotep III

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- [Significance](#) of the geographical setting, natural features and resources of New Kingdom Egypt
- The nature and range of [sources](#) for this period

Evaluation

- Issues of [ancient](#) sources in understanding this society

Example(s):

Availability of sources, gaps in the evidence, relevant historiographical issues.

- Differing [modern](#) interpretations of a feature of this society

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the extent of obsession with death and the afterlife, or the extent and role of slavery.

Social and political organisation

- The roles and images of the pharaoh and the concept of Ma'at
- The roles of the vizier and members of the religious, administrative and military elites
- The roles and status of royal and non-royal women
- The roles and status of scribes, artisans and agricultural workers
- The nature and significance of the army

Economic activities

- The importance of the Nile
- Economic exchange, including taxation, booty, tribute and trade
- Role of occupations, crafts and industry
- Technology, including building techniques and irrigation works

Religious ideology and practice

- Gods and goddesses, cults and priesthoods
- The role of festivals, including Opet, Beautiful Feast of the Valley and Heb-Sed
- Funerary customs, rituals, afterlife concepts and mummification
- Funerary texts, including *The book of the dead* and the *Amduat*
- The architecture and function of temples, including those at Karnak and Luxor
- The architecture and decoration of tombs

Cultural life

- Writing and literature, including wisdom literature and the Papyrus Ebers

New Kingdom Egypt during the Ramesside period

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- [Significance](#) of the geographical setting, natural features and resources of New Kingdom Egypt
- The nature and range of [sources](#) for this period

Evaluation

- Issues of [ancient](#) sources in understanding this society

Example(s):

Availability of sources, gaps in the evidence, relevant historiographical issues.

- Differing [modern](#) interpretations of a feature of this society

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the extent of obsession with death and the afterlife, or the extent and role of slavery.

Social and political organisation

- The roles and images of the pharaoh and the concept of Ma'at
- The roles of the vizier and members of the religious, administrative and military elites
- The roles and status of royal and non-royal women
- The roles and status of scribes, artisans and agricultural workers
- The nature and significance of the army

Economic activities

- The importance of the Nile
- Economic exchange, including taxation, tribute and trade

- Role of occupations, crafts and industry
- Technology, including building techniques and irrigation works
- Workers' strikes, tomb robberies and corruption

Religious ideology and practice

- Gods and goddesses, cults and priesthoods
- Personal religion, including magic and personal piety
- The role of festivals, including Opet, Beautiful Feast of the Valley and Heb-Sed
- Funerary customs, rituals, afterlife concepts and mummification
- Funerary texts, including *The book of the dead*, the *Amduat* and *The book of gates*
- The architecture and function of temples, including the Ramesseum and Medinet Habu
- The architecture and decoration of tombs

Cultural life

- Writing and literature, including *The tale of two brothers* and *The report of Wenamun*

Israel from Solomon to the fall of Samaria

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- [Significance](#) of the geographical setting, natural features and resources of [ancient](#) Israel
- The nature and range of [sources](#) for this period

Evaluation

- Issues of ancient sources in understanding this society

Example(s):

Availability of sources, gaps in the evidence, relevant historiographical issues.

- Differing [modern](#) interpretations of a feature of this society

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the emergence of monotheism, or the extent of conflict between religious traditions.

Social and political organisation

- The roles and features of Israelite kingship and the Davidic dynasty
- The roles and importance of prophets in Israelite society, including Elijah, Amos, Elisha and Hosea
- The roles and status of the bureaucracy, landowners, merchant class, workers, artisans and enslaved people
- The roles and status of royal and non-royal women
- The nature and significance of the army

Economic activities

- The role of agriculture, industry, crafts and occupations
- Economic exchange, including trade with Judah and Assyria
- Features of fortified cities, including silos and the Megiddo stables

Religious ideology and practice

- The range of religious beliefs and practices, including polytheism, Ba'al and Yahweh
- The roles of priests and prophets
- The roles and importance of religious places, including the Jerusalem Temple

Cultural life

- Art and architecture
- Writing and literature, including the Biblical narrative and Samarian Ostraca

Persia in the time of Darius and Xerxes

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- [Significance](#) of the geographical setting, natural features of [ancient](#) Persia and its empire
- The nature and range of [sources](#) for this period

Evaluation

- Issues of ancient sources in understanding this society

Example(s):

Availability of sources, gaps in the evidence, relevant historiographical issues.

- Differing [modern](#) interpretations of a feature of this society

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the importance of women in the Persian court, or the extent of religious tolerance.

Social and political organisation

- The roles and images of the king
- The roles and status of royal and non-royal women
- Administration of the empire, including the role of the *hazarapatis* and *satraps*
- The nature and significance of the army and navy
- Subject peoples in the empire

Economic activities

- The role of agriculture, occupations, crafts and industry

- Economic exchange throughout the empire, including taxation, tribute, trade, coinage and royal treasuries
- Technology, including building techniques, irrigation works and the Royal Road

Religious ideology and practice

- Religious policy and the range of beliefs throughout the empire, including the worship of Ahura Mazda, Bel Marduk and Yahweh
- Rituals and practice, including the role of the Magi and fire rituals
- Royal funerary customs and tombs

Cultural life

- The art and architecture of palace complexes, including Persepolis, Pasargadae and Susa

China during the Han dynasty

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- [Significance](#) of the geographical setting, natural features and resources of ancient China
- The nature and range of [sources](#) for this period

Evaluation

- Issues of [ancient](#) sources in understanding this society

Example(s):

Availability of sources, gaps in the evidence, relevant historiographical issues.

- Differing [modern](#) interpretations of a feature of this society

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the role of Confucianism in politics, or the extent of control and/or dissent.

Social and political organisation

- The roles and images of the emperor and the Mandate of Heaven
- The roles and hierarchy of the imperial bureaucracy, including scholars, court officials and eunuchs
- The role of provincial administrators, including the royal family and the local elite
- The roles and status of royal and non-royal women
- Imperial Confucianism and its role in politics and social structure
- The nature and significance of the army

Economic activities

- The importance of agriculture
- Economic exchange throughout the empire, including taxation, trade, government monopolies and coinage
- The role of occupations, crafts and industry
- Technology, including metallurgy, weapons, road and canal systems

Religious ideology and practice

- Religious beliefs, including Daoism, chief deities and the Cult of Heaven
- Imperial Confucianism, including cosmological beliefs
- Rituals and practice, including sacrifices, rites and divination
- Funerary beliefs and customs, the afterlife, spirits and ancestor worship, and the Cult of the Dead
- Tombs and their architecture, decoration and function

Cultural life

- Writing and literature, including Sima Qian's *Shiji* and the poetry of Sima Xiangru

Minoan Crete in the Bronze Age

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- [Significance](#) of the geographical setting, natural features and resources of Minoan Crete
- The nature and range of [sources](#) for this period

Evaluation

- Issues of [ancient](#) sources in understanding this society

Example(s):

Availability of sources, gaps in the evidence, relevant historiographical issues.

- Differing [modern](#) interpretations of a feature of this society

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the nature of society: peaceful/warlike, patriarchal/matriarchal or the nature of kingship.

Social and political organisation

- Issues relating to the gender and identity of the ruler(s)
- The roles of the palace elite, bureaucracy, priests and priestesses
- The roles and status of women
- Craftsmen and agricultural workers

Economic activities

- The palace economy and the role of towns
- Agriculture, trade and economic exchange
- The concept of thalassocracy

- The role of occupations, crafts and industry
- Technology, including building techniques and ashlar masonry

Religious ideology and practice

- Myths and legends relating to the Minoans, including Theseus and the Minotaur
- Religious symbols, including the labrys and the 'horns of consecration'
- Religious places, including peak sanctuaries, pillar crypts and lustral basins
- Funerary customs, rituals and tombs

Cultural life

- Art, including frescoes, pottery and seals
- The architecture of palace complexes, including Knossos and Phaistos

Sparta to the Battle of Leuctra 371 BCE

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- [Significance](#) of the geographical setting, natural features and resources of ancient Sparta
- The nature and range of [sources](#) for this period

Evaluation

- Issues of [ancient](#) sources in understanding this society

Example(s):

Availability of sources, gaps in the evidence, relevant historiographical issues such as the views of Greek writers like Xenophon and Plutarch.

- Differing [modern](#) interpretations of a feature of this society

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the development or extent of the militaristic nature of society; existence of Lycurgus.

Social and political organisation

- The Great Rhetra and the issue of Lycurgus
- The roles and privileges of the 2 kings
- Structure and features of government, including *gerousia*, *ephorate* and *ekklesia*
- Roles and hierarchy, including *Spartiates*, *perioikoi*, *hypomeiones* and helots
- The roles and status of women
- The nature and role of the *agōgē*
- The nature and significance of the Spartan army
- Control of the helots

Economic activities

- Land ownership and agriculture, *kleroi* and helots
- The role of occupations, crafts and industry

Religious ideology and practice

- Gods and goddesses, including Artemis Orthia and Apollo
- The role of festivals, including the *Hyakinthia*, *Gymnopaedia* and *Karneia*
- Funerary customs and rituals

Cultural life

- The writing of Alcman and Tyrtaeus

Athens in the time of Pericles

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- [Significance](#) of the geographical setting, natural features and resources of Athens and Attica
- The nature and range of [sources](#) for this period

Evaluation

- Issues of [ancient](#) sources in understanding this society

Example(s):

Availability of sources, gaps in the evidence, relevant historiographical issues.

- Differing [modern](#) interpretations of a feature of this society

Example(s):

Differing interpretations of the motivations of democratic leaders as principled or pragmatic, the extent of democracy.

Social and political organisation

- The concept of the *polis* and the *demos*
- Roles and hierarchy, including *pentakosiomedimnoi*, *hippeis*, *zeugitai*, *thetes*, *metics* and enslaved people
- The roles and status of women
- Structure and features of government, including the *ekklesia*, *boule*, *strategia* and *heliaea*
- The nature and significance of the military

Economic activities

- The importance of the Agora and the Piraeus

- The impact of empire, including tribute, maintenance of fleet and building program
- Economic exchange, including trade, shipping, silver mining and coinage
- The role of occupations, crafts and industry

Religious ideology and practice

- Gods and goddesses
- The practices of priests and priestesses
- Temples and sanctuaries, including the Acropolis
- The role of festivals, including the Panathenaia, the Great Dionysia and the Thesmophoria
- Funerary customs and rituals

Cultural life

- Art and architecture
- Writing and literature, including playwrights

Historical personalities

Students develop an understanding of ONE [ancient](#) personality, through the investigation of a range of archaeological and written [sources](#) and relevant historiographical issues.

The historical [concepts](#) and skills content is to be integrated as appropriate.

Students study key features of ONE of the following personalities:

- Egypt – Hatshepsut
- Egypt – Akhenaten
- The Near East – Xerxes
- China – Qin Shi Huangdi
- Greece – Pericles
- Greece – Alexander the Great
- Rome – Julius Caesar
- Rome – Agrippina the Younger.

Egypt – Hatshepsut

Outcomes

A student:

- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The geography of Egypt and its neighbours
- The political and religious roles of the Egyptian king and queen

Background

- Family background
- Marriage to Thutmose II
- Claim to the throne and succession, including the Divine Birth and Coronation reliefs

Key features and developments

- Religious policy, including devotion to Amun and the promotion of other cults
- Building programs, including Deir el-Bahri, Karnak, Speos Artemidos and the tombs of Hatshepsut

- Foreign policy and military campaigns, including the expedition to Punt
- Titles and changes to Hatshepsut's royal image over time
- Relationship with the Amun priesthood, nobles and officials, including Senenmut
- Relationship with Thutmose III, co-regency and later defacement of Hatshepsut's monuments

Evaluation

- Impact and influence
- [Ancient](#) and [modern](#) images and interpretations of Hatshepsut
- Problems of [evidence](#), including the value and limitations of ONE ancient [source](#) or type of source, in the context of other available sources

Example(s):

The Divine Birth and Coronation reliefs; Deir el-Bahri.

Egypt – Akhenaten

Outcomes

A student:

- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The geography of Egypt and its neighbours
- The roles and images of Egyptian kings

Background

- Family background and early years
- Marriage, queens and consorts
- Relationship with Amenhotep III

Key features and developments

- Early building program, including East Karnak
- The political and religious motives for the transfer of the capital to Akhetaten
- The function and layout of Akhetaten
- The nature and impact of religious policies
- Artistic innovations and [representations](#) of the Aten, Akhenaten and the royal family
- The role of Nefertiti and the issue of the co-regency
- Foreign policy towards Nubia and the Levant

Evaluation

- Impact and influence
- [Ancient](#) and [modern](#) images and interpretations of Akhenaten
- Problems of [evidence](#), including the value and limitations of ONE ancient [source](#) or type of source, in the context of other available sources

Example(s):

The Amarna Letters; Amarna tombs.

The Near East – Xerxes

Outcomes

A student:

- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The geography of the Persian Empire and its neighbours
- The roles and images of Persian kings

Background

- Family background and status
- Succession to the kingship

Key features and developments

- Administration of the Persian Empire
- Revolts in Egypt and Babylon
- Religious policy
- Building programs in Persepolis
- Foreign policy, including Xerxes's role in the invasion of the Greek mainland
- Relationship with prominent Persians and non-Persians

Example(s):

Artemisia, Atossa, Mardonius.

- The manner and impact of Xerxes's death

Evaluation

- Impact and influence
- [Ancient](#) and [modern](#) images and interpretations of Xerxes

- Problems of [evidence](#), including the value and limitations of ONE ancient [source](#) or type of source, in the context of other available sources

Example(s):

Herodotus's *The histories* Books VII to IX; Persepolis.

China – Qin Shi Huangdi

Outcomes

A student:

- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The geography of China and its neighbours
- The legacy of the Warring States period 411–221 BCE

Background

- Family background and status
- Succession to the kingship of Qin
- Regency and the relationship with Lü Buwei
- Early career, including the attempted coup of Lao Ai

Key features and developments

- Wars of conquest
- Role in the establishment of imperial power, including policies, standardisation and titles
- Relationship with court officials, including Li Si
- The organisation and administration of the empire, including commanderies and counties, the road system and royal tours
- Building program in Xi'an, provincial and defensive projects
- The search for immortality and the construction of the emperor's mausoleum
- Assassination attempts
- The manner and impact of Qin Shi Huangdi's death

Evaluation

- Impact and influence
- [Ancient](#) and [modern](#) images and interpretations of Qin Shi Huangdi

- Problems of [evidence](#), including the value and limitations of ONE ancient [source](#) or type of source, in the context of other available sources

Example(s):

The Mausoleum of the First Emperor; Sima Qian's *Shiji* Book VI.

Greece – Pericles

Outcomes

A student:

- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The geography of Athens and its neighbours
- An overview of the development of Athenian democracy

Background

- Family background and education
- Early career until 460 BCE

Key features and developments

- Democratic reforms and policies
- Building program
- Roles as *strategos* and politician
- Methods of maintaining leadership and influence
- Influence on the development of Athenian imperialism
- Role and influence in the development of Athens and the 'Golden Age'
- Relationships with prominent individuals

Example(s):

Aspasia, Ephialtes, Pheidias.

- Role in the outbreak of the Peloponnesian War and Pericles's leadership and strategies during the war
- The manner and impact of his death

Evaluation

- Impact and influence
- [Ancient](#) and [modern](#) images and interpretations of Pericles

- Problems of [evidence](#), including the value and limitations of ONE ancient [source](#) or type of source, in the context of other available sources

Example(s):

Thucydides's *History of the Peloponnesian War Book II*; the Acropolis.

Greece – Alexander the Great

Outcomes

A student:

- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The geography of Macedon and its neighbours
- The impact of Philip II's military reforms

Background

- Family background
- Education, early life and ambitions
- Problems with the succession

Key features and developments

- The impact of the assassination of Philip II
- The consolidation of Macedonian control of the Greek mainland
- Generalship and military campaigns, including the Battles of Granicus, Issus, Gaugamela and Hydaspes
- The organisation and administration of the empire, the foundation of cities, and marriages
- Relationship with the army and generals
- Relationship with prominent Macedonians, Greeks and non-Greeks

Example(s):

Aristotle, Hephaestion, Olympias, Parmenion.

- The manner and impact of Alexander the Great's death

Evaluation

- Impact and influence
- [Ancient](#) and [modern](#) images and interpretations of Alexander the Great

- Problems of [evidence](#), including the value and limitations of ONE ancient [source](#) or type of source, in the context of other available sources

Example(s):

Arrian's *The anabasis of Alexander*; coinage.

Rome – Julius Caesar

Outcomes

A student:

- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The geography of Rome and the provinces
- An overview of the legacy of Marius and Sulla

Background

- Family background and status
- Education, early life and ambitions
- Paths to power, including priesthoods, Marian connections, political alliances and marriages

Key features and developments

- Role in the First Triumvirate
- Campaigns and tactics of the Gallic War, including the siege of Alesia
- Relationship with his army
- Relationship with the Senate
- Role in the Civil War
- Relationships with prominent individuals

Example(s):

Cicero, Cleopatra VII, Mark Antony.

- Dictatorship, policies and reforms
- The motives for his assassination
- The manner and impact of his death

Evaluation

- Impact and influence
- [Ancient](#) and [modern](#) images and interpretations of Julius Caesar

- Problems of [evidence](#), including the value and limitations of ONE ancient [source](#) or type of source, in the context of other available sources

Example(s):

Plutarch's *Life of Julius Caesar*; statuary.

Rome – Agrippina the Younger

Outcomes

A student:

- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The geography of Rome and the provinces
- The role of imperial women in Roman society

Background

- Family background and status
- Early life, influences and ambitions
- Marriages

Key features and developments

- Role during the reign of Gaius
- The basis of her power and influence, including public image and patronage
- Role during the reign of Claudius
- Role and changing relationship with Nero during his reign
- Relationships with other members of the imperial court

Example(s):

Burrus, Pallas, Seneca.

- The motives for her assassination
- The manner and impact of Agrippina's death

Evaluation

- Impact and influence
- [Ancient](#) and [modern](#) images and interpretations of Agrippina the Younger

- Problems of [evidence](#), including the value and limitations of ONE ancient [source](#) or type of source, in the context of other available sources

Example(s):

Tacitus's *Annals*; coinage.

Historical periods

Through an investigation of the archaeological and written [sources](#) of ONE historical period, students learn about the nature of power and authority, significant developments that shaped the historical period, and relevant historiographical issues.

The historical [concepts](#) and skills content is to be integrated as appropriate.

Students study key features of ONE of the following historical periods:

- New Kingdom Egypt to the death of Thutmose IV
- New Kingdom Egypt – Amenhotep III to the death of Ramesses II
- The Levant in the period c. 869–586 BCE
- Persia – Cyrus II to the death of Darius III
- Imperial China – the Qin and Han 247–87 BCE
- The Greek world 500–440 BCE
- Greece from 404 BCE to the death of Philip II
- The fall of the Roman Republic 78–42 BCE
- The Augustan Age 44 BCE–14 CE
- The Julio-Claudians 14–68 CE.

New Kingdom Egypt to the death of Thutmose IV

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The chronological and geographical context of Egypt in the Near East
- The establishment of the Eighteenth Dynasty, and the reunification of Upper and Lower Egypt

Internal developments

- The impact of the Hyksos
- The role and contributions of rulers from Ahmose to Thutmose IV
- The role and contributions of queens, including Tetisheri, Ahhotep I and Ahmose-Nefertari

- The development and importance of the cult of Amun
- The political and religious [significance](#) of building programs

Foreign relations

- Development and role of the army
- The nature of Egyptian imperialism
- The establishment and maintenance of the 'empire'
- Relations with foreign powers, including the Mitanni
- The role of the image of the 'warrior pharaoh'

New Kingdom Egypt – Amenhotep III to the death of Ramesses II

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The chronological and geographical context of Egypt in the Near East
- Features of Eighteenth Dynasty political and religious authority

Internal developments

- The role and contribution of rulers from Amenhotep III to Ramesses II
- The Amarna 'revolution' and the reasons for its failure
- Post-Amarna reforms, restoration of Amun and other gods
- Political and religious [significance](#) of building programs
- The changing role and contribution of queens, including Tiye, Nefertiti, Ankhesenamun and Nefertari

Foreign relations

- The maintenance and administration of the 'empire' in Nubia
- The maintenance and administration of the 'sphere of influence' in the Levant, including the relationship with vassal rulers
- Ramesside imperialism, military campaigns and their impacts on Egyptian–Hittite relations
- The course and consequences of the Battle of Kadesh, including the Egyptian–Hittite peace treaty
- The role of the image of the 'warrior pharaoh'

The Levant in the period c. 869–586 BCE

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The chronological and geographical context of the Levant in the Near East
- The legacy of the reigns of David, Solomon and Rehoboam

Israel and Judah in the Ancient Levant

- Changing relations between the northern kingdom of Israel and the southern kingdom of Judah, 869–722 BCE
- Interactions with Aramaean city-states and kingdoms in the 9th century to 586 BCE
- Interactions with other city-states and kingdoms in the 9th century to 586 BCE, including Edom and Moab
- Egypt's influence on foreign relations in the Levant in the late 8th century to 586 BCE
- The relationship between religious and foreign policy

Foreign relations with Assyria and Babylon

- Israel's relationship with Assyria in the 9th to 7th centuries BCE
- The Assyrian conquest of the northern kingdom of Israel and its capital Samaria in 722 BCE
- Judah's relationship with Assyria in the 9th to 7th centuries BCE
- The campaign of Assyrian King Sennacherib against Judah 701 BCE
- Judah's relationship with Babylon 701–586 BCE

Persia – Cyrus II to the death of Darius III

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The chronological and geographical context of Persia in the Near East and Asia
- The decline of the kingdoms of Babylon and Media

The establishment and expansion of the Persian Empire

- The reign of Cyrus II and the establishment of the Achaemenid dynasty
- The role and contribution of kings from Cambyses II to Darius III
- The nature and [significance](#) of Persian kingship
- The nature and significance of building programs
- The role and significance of the Persian army
- The impact on Persia of the invasions of mainland Greece under Darius I and Xerxes I
- The suppression of revolts and treatment of subject peoples, including Egypt, Babylon and the Jews
- The maintenance and administration of the empire

The collapse of the Persian Empire

- The Macedonian invasion and the defeat of Darius III
- Reasons for the collapse of the Persian Empire

Imperial China – the Qin and Han 247–87 BCE

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The chronological and geographical context of China in Asia
- An overview of the Warring States period 411–221 BCE

The rise and fall of the Qin dynasty

- Reasons for the success of the Qin, including the unification of the Warring States
- The creation of the position of emperor and the nature of imperial power
- The political, legal and cultural reforms of the Qin
- The role and contribution of Li Si
- Reasons for the fall of the Qin, including the problems of succession

The establishment of the Han dynasty

- The role and contribution of emperors from Gaozu to Jingdi
- The nature and role of Confucianism in the Han government
- The role of empress dowagers
- The reign of Emperor Wudi and his political and cultural reforms

The empire of the Han

- Expansion of the empire, including wars against the Xiongnu
- The control and maintenance of the empire, including resistance and rebellion
- Administration of the empire

The Greek world 500–440 BCE

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The chronological and geographical context of Greece in the Mediterranean and the Near East
- The origins of the Persian Wars, including Persian imperialism and the Ionian Revolt

The Persian Wars

- The invasion of 490 BCE, the Battle of Marathon and the role of Miltiades
- The interwar period, including preparation and developments in Persia and Greece
- The invasion of 480–479 BCE and the Battles of Thermopylae, Artemisium, Salamis, Plataea and Mycale
- The role and contribution of Themistocles, Leonidas, Pausanias and Eurybiades
- Reasons for Greek victory and Persian defeat
- The impact of the Persian Wars on relations between Athens and Sparta

Athens and the Athenian Empire

- The Delian League and its origins, aims, organisation and activities to the Battle of the Eurymedon River
- The role and contribution of Cimon and Aristides the Just to the Delian League
- The transformation of the Delian League into the Athenian Empire
- The impact of Athenian imperialism on Athens, its democracy and citizens
- The impact of Athenian imperialism on its allies, including changing relations
- Spartan responses to Athenian imperialism

Greece from 404 BCE to the death of Philip II

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The chronological and geographical context of Greece in the Mediterranean and the Near East
- The legacy of the Peloponnesian War and the nature of Spartan hegemony

Significant developments 404–362 BCE

- The role and [significance](#) of Lysander and Agesilaus II, the Corinthian War
- Persian intervention in Greece and the significance of the King's Peace
- The influence of the Second Athenian Confederacy
- Consequences of the Battle of Leuctra 371 BCE
- The nature and impact of Theban hegemony, including the role of Pelopidas and Epaminondas

Greece and the rise of Macedon

- The significance of the Battle of Mantinea 362 BCE
- The nature of Macedonian kingship and the accession of Philip II
- Philip's reforms of the Macedonian army
- Macedonian expansion into Greece, including diplomacy and war
- The significance of the Battle of Chaeronea 338 BCE
- Opposition to Philip, including Demosthenes
- The motives for the assassination of Philip II and the impact of his death

The fall of the Roman Republic 78–42 BCE

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The chronological and geographical context of Rome in the Mediterranean and the Near East
- The legacy of Marius and Sulla

Political developments in the late Republic

- The [significance](#) of Pompey's military and political career, including the consulship of 70 BCE, his extraordinary commands and the Eastern Settlement
- The role and significance of Cicero
- The aims, roles and activities of Pompey, Crassus and Caesar in the First Triumvirate
- The significance of Caesar's military campaigns
- The role and influence of the Senate

Example(s):

Political factions – the *optimates* and *populares*; the influence of Cato the Younger.

- Political crises, including the use of the army for political purposes and urban violence

The Civil War and the fall of the Republic

- The breakdown of the First Triumvirate and the outbreak of the Civil War 49–45 BCE
- The Civil War from Pharsalus to Munda
- The significance of Caesar's dictatorship
- Reasons for the assassination of Caesar
- The impact of the assassination of Caesar, including political instability, the formation of the Second Triumvirate and the Battles of Philippi

The Augustan Age 44 BCE–14 CE

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The chronological and geographical context of Rome in the Mediterranean and the Near East
- The early career of Octavian, the Second Triumvirate and the outcome of the Civil War

The Augustan principate

- Development of the principate, including the settlements of 27 BCE and 23 BCE
- The roles and responsibilities of Augustus and the Senate
- Titles, honours and images of the princeps
- The roles of officials, equestrians and freedmen in the administration of the principate
- Augustan reforms, including political, social, legal, religious and administrative reforms
- Opposition to Augustus's rule
- The nature and [significance](#) of Augustus's building programs
- Literature and propaganda, including the role of Maecenas
- The imperial family and problems of succession
- The role and influence of imperial women, including Livia and Julia
- The role and contribution of Agrippa

The empire under Augustus

- Augustus and the army
- The nature of provincial government, including imperial and senatorial provinces
- Frontier policy and instability

The Julio-Claudians 14–68 CE

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses continuity and change in the ancient world **AH-12-01**
- proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments **AH-12-02**
- assesses the role and significance of forces, features, events, individuals and groups in shaping the past **AH-12-03**
- analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context **AH-12-04**
- evaluates different types of sources for evidence to support a historical account or argument **AH-12-05**
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past **AH-12-06**
- communicates historical understanding, integrating historical knowledge, terms and concepts **AH-12-07**

Related Life Skills outcomes: AH-LS-03, AH-LS-04, AH-LS-05, AH-LS-06, AH-LS-07, AH-LS-08, AH-LS-09, AH-LS-10, AH-LS-11

Content

Context

- The chronological and geographical context of Rome in the Mediterranean and the Near East
- The legacy of Augustus

The development of the principate under the Julio-Claudian rulers

- The changing nature of the principate and role of the princeps: Tiberius, Gaius, Claudius and Nero
- The changing roles and responsibilities of the Senate
- The political role of the Praetorian Guard
- The role and influence of imperial women, including Livia, Julia, Agrippina the Elder and Agrippina the Younger
- The imperial family and problems of succession
- The changing image of the princeps, including the development of the imperial cult throughout the empire
- The reforms and policies of the Julio-Claudian rulers
- The nature and [significance](#) of building programs under the Julio-Claudian rulers
- The development of the imperial bureaucracy, including the role of freedmen
- The role of Nero in the fall of the Julio-Claudian dynasty

The empire

- The political role of the army and its relationship with the princeps

- Expansion and consolidation of the empire, including resistance and rebellions

Example(s):

The invasion of Britain (43 CE), the First Roman–Jewish War (66–73 CE), Boudicca’s revolt (60–61 CE), the Batavian revolt (69–70 CE).

Assessment

Course standards

Course standards are comprised of syllabus standards and performance standards. Syllabus outcomes and content form the syllabus standards that describe what students are expected to know, understand and do. Performance standards, including the Common Grade Scale for Preliminary courses, HSC Performance Band Descriptions and Achievement Level Descriptions (for HSC courses with grades only) describe how well students have achieved in relation to syllabus standards. Performance standards are used to report student achievement on NESA credentials.

Common Grade Scale for Preliminary courses

Stage 6 – Year 11

The [Common Grade Scale for Preliminary courses](#) provides generic, holistic descriptions for performance at each of the 5 grade levels. It is used to report student achievement in Year 11 courses in all NSW schools.

Performance Band Descriptions for Ancient History

Stage 6 – Year 12

HSC performance band descriptions summarise the knowledge, understanding and skills typically demonstrated by students at each band level in a particular course. NESA uses these holistic descriptions to report a student's overall level of achievement in an HSC course.

Band 6

A student who performs at this level typically:

- demonstrates extensive knowledge and understanding of a range of forces, features, individuals, groups, events and developments, and their significance
- demonstrates comprehensive understanding of continuity and change
- demonstrates comprehensive understanding of different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context
- evaluates sources for evidence to support historical accounts and arguments
- evaluates differing interpretations and representations of the past
- communicates sophisticated understanding through highly developed and sustained arguments and integration of historical concepts and terms.

Band 5

A student who performs at this level typically:

- demonstrates thorough knowledge and understanding of a range of forces, features, individuals, groups, events and developments, and their significance
- demonstrates a well-developed understanding of continuity and change
- demonstrates a well-developed understanding of different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context
- analyses sources for evidence to support historical accounts and arguments
- analyses differing interpretations and representations of the past
- communicates thorough understanding through sustained arguments and integration of historical concepts and terms.

Band 4

A student who performs at this level typically:

- demonstrates sound knowledge and understanding of a range of forces, features, individuals, groups, events and developments, and their significance
- demonstrates a sound understanding of continuity and change
- demonstrates a sound understanding of different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context
- uses sources for evidence in historical accounts or arguments
- discusses interpretations and representations of the past
- communicates understanding through generalised arguments and sound use of historical concepts and terms.

Band 3

A student who performs at this level typically:

- demonstrates basic understanding of forces, features, individuals, groups, events and developments, and their significance
- identifies features of continuity and change
- demonstrates basic understanding of different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context
- makes reference to sources in historical accounts
- identifies interpretations and representations of the past
- communicates basic information through descriptive texts with basic use of historical concepts and terms.

Band 2

A student who performs at this level typically:

- describes historical forces, features, individuals, groups, events and developments
- recognises aspects of continuity and/or change
- demonstrates limited understanding of different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context
- communicates limited information with limited use of historical concepts and terms.

Band 1

Performance reported as Band 1 indicates that the minimum standard expected was not demonstrated.

School-based assessment

Schools are required to develop an assessment program for each Year 11 and Year 12 course. NESAs provide information about the responsibilities of schools in developing assessment programs in course-specific assessment requirements and in the Assessment Certification Examination (ACE) rules and requirements.

Year 11 Ancient History school-based assessment

Stage 6 – Year 11

Schools are required to submit to NESAs a grade for each student based on their achievement at the end of the course.

Teachers use professional, on-balance judgement to allocate grades based on the Common Grade Scale for Preliminary courses.

Teachers consider all available assessment information, including formal and informal assessment, to determine the grade that best matches each student's achievement at the end of the course.

See [Assessment Certification Examination \(ACE\) rules and requirements](#) for further information.

Assessment programs must reflect course components and weightings

The course components and component weightings for Year 11 are mandatory.

Course component	Weighting %
Knowledge and understanding of course content	40
Historical skills in the analysis and evaluation of sources and interpretations	20
Historical inquiry and research	20
Communication of historical understanding	20

Schools may determine specific elements of their assessment program

Schools have authority to determine the number, type of task and the weighting allocated to an assessment task. Schools may also follow the sample assessment programs provided by NESAs.

Sample assessment program

NESA's sample Year 11 formal school-based assessment program for Ancient History is:

- 3 assessment tasks, including:
 - a Historical Investigation
 - a formal written examination
 - a weighting for any individual task of 20% to 40%.

Some students with disability may require [adjustments](#) in order to access assessment opportunities and demonstrate achievement of outcomes.

Information about the Historical Investigation

The Historical Investigation may be undertaken as a standalone investigation or integrated into any focus area in the Year 11 course.

The investigation must not overlap with, or duplicate significantly, any option in the Ancient History or History Extension courses.

Year 12 Ancient History school-based assessment

Stage 6 – Year 12

NESA requires schools to submit a school-based assessment mark for each Year 12 student who completes this course. Formal school-based assessment tasks should reflect the syllabus outcomes and content. The mark submitted by the school provides a summation of each student's achievement measured at several points throughout the course.

A school's program of school-based assessment includes both mandatory and non-mandatory elements.

See [Assessment Certification Examination \(ACE\) rules and requirements](#) for further information.

Assessment programs must reflect course components and weightings

The course components and component weightings for Year 12 are mandatory.

Course component	Weighting %
Knowledge and understanding of course content	40
Historical skills in the analysis and evaluation of sources and interpretations	20
Historical inquiry and research	20
Communication of historical understanding	20

Schools may determine specific elements of their assessment program

Schools have authority to determine the number, type of task and the weighting allocated to an assessment task. Schools may also follow the sample assessment programs provided by NESAs.

Sample assessment program

NESA's sample Year 12 formal school-based assessment program for Ancient History is:

- 4 assessment tasks, including:
 - a Historical Analysis with a weighting of 20% to 30%
 - a formal written examination
 - a weighting for any individual task of 10% to 40%.

Some students with disability may require [adjustments](#) in order to access assessment opportunities and demonstrate achievement of outcomes.

Historical Analysis

The Historical Analysis provides students with the opportunity to focus on a historical question, issue or controversy of interest, and to develop a reasoned argument, supported by evidence. It may occur in or across any of the Year 12 options selected for study.

The Historical Analysis may be presented in written, oral or multimodal form, and should:

- be completed individually
- be a maximum of 1200 words, 6 minutes duration or equivalent in multimodal form
- address relevant syllabus outcomes
- relate to a Year 12 option(s) studied in the *Ancient History 11–12 Syllabus*.

Sample assessment schedules

Stage 6

- [Sample assessment schedule Year 11: A](#)
- [Sample assessment schedule Year 11: B](#)
- [Sample assessment schedule Year 12: A](#)
- [Sample assessment schedule Year 12: B](#)

Sample assessment task notifications

Stage 6

- [Sample formal assessment task notification: Year 11 \(Source analysis portfolio – Features of ancient societies: Death and funerary customs in Greece and Rome\)](#)
- [Sample formal assessment task notification: Year 12 \(Historical analysis – Historical personalities: Greece – Alexander the Great\)](#)
- [Sample formal assessment task notification: Year 12 \(In-class source analysis – Ancient societies: New Kingdom Egypt during the Ramesside period\)](#)
- [Sample formal assessment task notification: Year 12 \(Source analysis portfolio – Cities of Vesuvius – Pompeii and Herculaneum\)](#)

Further information

Stage 6 – Year 12

- [Assessment in Stage 6](#)
- [Principles of effective assessment](#)
- [Assessment in practice](#)
- [School-based assessment requirements](#)
- [Adjustments to assessment for students with disability](#)
- [Life Skills](#)
- [Assessment Certification Examination \(ACE\)](#)

HSC examinations

The external HSC examination measures student achievement in a range of syllabus outcomes.

The external examination and its marking relate to the syllabus by:

- providing clear links to syllabus outcomes
- enabling students to demonstrate the levels of achievement outlined in the Performance Band Descriptions
- applying marking guidelines based on criteria that relate to the quality of the response
- aligning performance in the examination each year to the standards established for the course.

Examination questions may require students to integrate knowledge, understanding and skills developed through studying the course.

The Year 11 course is assumed knowledge for the Year 12 course.

Some students with disability may be eligible for [HSC exam provisions](#) when completing the HSC examination.

Ancient History HSC examination specifications

Stage 6 – Year 12

The examination will consist of a written paper worth 100 marks.

Time allowed: 3 hours plus 10 minutes reading time.

The paper will consist of four sections.

Questions may include sources and/or interpretations.

Context content points in the syllabus will not be examined on their own. However, they may be integrated into examination questions.

Section I – Core study: Cities of Vesuvius – Pompeii and Herculaneum (25 marks)

- There will be three or four questions.

- Students will be required to answer all questions.
- One question will be worth 10 to 15 marks.
- Students will be required to analyse and interpret sources.

Section II – Ancient societies (25 marks)

- There will be one question for each of the eight options.
- Students will be required to answer the question on the option they have studied.
- Each question will contain three or four parts.
- One part will be worth 10 to 15 marks.

Section III – Historical personalities (25 marks)

- There will be one question for each of the eight options.
- Students will be required to answer the question on the option they have studied.
- Each question will contain two or three parts.
- At least one part will be worth 10 to 15 marks.

Section IV – Historical periods (25 marks)

- There will be one extended-response question for each of the ten options.
- Each question will have two alternatives.
- Students will be required to answer one alternative on the option they have studied.

HSC Ancient History – annotated sample examination materials

Stage 6 – Year 12

- [HSC Ancient History – annotated sample examination materials](#)

Further information

Stage 6 – Year 12

- [Assessment in Stage 6](#)
- [Principles of effective assessment](#)
- [Assessment in practice](#)
- [School-based assessment requirements](#)
- [Adjustments to assessment for students with disability](#)
- [Life Skills](#)
- [Assessment Certification Examination \(ACE\)](#)